

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)

USSD Seed Sales & Farmer Extension Platform

Project Title: *Mbeu Zanga – Integrated USSD Commerce & Farmer Extension System*

Date of Issue: 15 January 2026

Proposal Deadline: Friday, 30 January 2026, 5:00 PM CAT

Inquiries: Strictly by email only info@globalseedsmw.com

RFP Reference: GSM-RFP-2026-001

1. Background on Global Seeds Malawi

Global Seeds Malawi is a locally owned agribusiness specializing in the production, processing, and distribution of high-quality certified seed for smallholder farmers across Malawi. Through our extensive network of growers, agro-dealers, and development partners, we supply improved maize, legume, and horticultural seed varieties tailored to Malawi's diverse agro-ecological zones. We are committed to strengthening national food security by improving farmer access to reliable seed and practical extension support. More information about our work is available at www.globalseedsmw.com.

As part of our digital transformation strategy, Global Seeds Malawi is launching this RFP to identify a technical partner capable of developing a modern USSD platform offering farmers a seamless way to purchase seed and receive timely agronomic advice.

2. Project Overview

Global Seeds Malawi seeks a qualified software development firm to design, develop, and deploy a robust USSD-based platform that enables smallholder farmers to:

- Purchase high-quality seed through mobile money (direct purchase or lay-by)
- Receive crop-specific extension messages, weather alerts, and seasonal guidance
- Access all services using basic feature phones without internet connectivity

The platform must be secure, scalable, and fully integrated with Malawi's mobile money ecosystem.

3. Project Scope & Objectives

The system must deliver two core functions:

A. Commerce

- Direct seed purchases via Airtel Money and TNM Mpamba
- A flexible lay-by system allowing farmers to make small, fixed payments over 3–6 months
- Order tracking and payment balance checks
- Product catalog with seed descriptions and pricing

B. Extension Services

- A structured library of crop-specific agronomic tips
- Push notifications aligned to planting cycles
- Weather, pest, and fertilizer advisory messages
- Content available in English and Chichewa

4. Core Functional Requirements

A. USSD Menu Structure (*XXXX#)

- **User Registration:** Farmer name, district, primary crop
- **Product Catalog:** Maize, legumes, horticulture, etc.
- **Lay-by Payments:** Multiple instalments via Airtel Money & Mpamba
- **Order Tracking:** Lay-by balance, delivery/collection status
- **Extension Library:** Planting, fertilizer application, pest control, harvesting

B. Backend Management Portal

- **Inventory Management:** Update seed availability and pricing
- **Payment Reconciliation:** Real-time dashboard for mobile money transactions
- **Bulk SMS Engine:** Send targeted extension messages (e.g., by district or crop)
- **User Analytics:** Farmer registration trends, product demand, usage statistics

5. Technical Specifications

- **Mobile Money Integration:** Mandatory integration with Airtel Money & TNM Mpamba APIs
- **Scalability:** Must support peak-season traffic (Oct–Dec)
- **Language Support:** English and Chichewa
- **Security:**
 - secure transaction logs
 - Secure farmer data storage
 - Role-based access control for backend users
- **Hosting:** Cloud-based or hybrid hosting

6. Deliverables

The selected vendor must provide:

- **System Requirements Specification (SRS)**
- **Fully Functional USSD Platform** (live code + backend dashboard)
- **Source Code:** Full ownership or licensed access
- **Training:** For Global Seeds Malawi staff on system management
- **12-Month SLA:** Technical support, bug fixes, and system monitoring

7. Submission Guidelines

Interested firms must submit a proposal containing:

- **Company Profile:** Experience in USSD, fintech, and integrations with Malawian telcos
- **Case Studies:** Minimum of two relevant projects (agri-input, microfinance, or mobile money systems)
- **Technical Approach:**
 - USSD architecture
 - Lay-by logic
 - API integration strategy
 - Security considerations
- **Project Timeline:** Development phases and expected delivery
- **Budget (Only in US Dollars for Non-Malawi Domiciled Companies):**
 - Development costs
 - Telco setup fees
 - Hosting and maintenance
 - SLA pricing

All proposals must be submitted electronically to info@globalseedsmw.com.

8. RFP Timeline

Activity	Date
Call Launch	15 January 2026
Proposal Submission Deadline	Friday, 30 January 2026
Review & Feedback to All Applicants	5 February 2026
Contracting & Kick-off	16 February 2026